

Authority Validation Standard - (AVS)

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Canonical Definition System

Canonical Definition

Authority Validation Standard (AVS) defines the structural conditions under which authority remains verifiable, legitimate, recognizable, traceable, governable, accountable, reconstructable, and operationally valid throughout its lifecycle.

AVS governs authority validation.

The standard establishes the foundational conditions required to determine whether authority claims, authority assignments, delegated authority structures, authority rights, authority privileges, and authority decisions remain valid and recognizable within governance environments.

Authority may exist.

Authority may be delegated.

Authority must also be validated.

AVS governs whether authority remains valid.

A. Standard Abstract

Modern governance systems depend upon valid authority.

Organizations validate authority.

Institutions validate authority.

Governments validate authority.

Professional bodies validate authority.

Certification systems validate authority.

AI governance systems increasingly require authority validation.

Without validation:

- authority may become illegitimate
- authority may become unverifiable
- authority may become expired
- authority may become fraudulent
- authority may become operationally unreliable
- accountability may become compromised

AVS exists to govern these conditions.

B. Core Principle

Authority validation becomes valid only when authority claims remain verifiable, legitimate, traceable, accountable, reconstructable, governable, and operationally valid throughout the authority lifecycle.

C. Scope

This standard may apply to:

- organizations
 - institutions
 - governments
 - regulatory environments
 - certification systems
 - supervisory structures
 - contractor networks
 - delegated authority systems
 - AI systems
 - autonomous agents
 - orchestrated agent systems
 - Human-AI governance environments
 - robotics ecosystems
 - distributed governance architectures
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- future intelligent operational systems

AVS applies wherever authority requires validation.

D. Why This Standard Exists

Authority alone does not guarantee legitimacy.

Delegated authority alone does not guarantee validity.

Governance systems frequently depend on assumptions regarding authority.

Examples include:

- professional certifications
- regulatory permissions
- organizational appointments
- delegated governance rights
- system privileges
- AI-agent permissions
- operational approvals
- supervisory rights

The challenge is not creating authority.

The challenge is determining whether authority remains valid.

AVS exists because authority validation has become a distinct governance space.

E. Authority Validation Integrity Logic

Authority validation integrity exists only when the following remain materially preservable:

1. Authority Validation Origin Integrity

Validation remains attributable to a legitimate validation source.

2. Authority Validation Criteria Integrity

Validation remains based upon identifiable and governable criteria.

3. Authority Validation Validity Integrity

Validation remains legitimate, recognized, and operationally valid.

4. Authority Validation Traceability Integrity

Validation remains reconstructable throughout its lifecycle.

5. Authority Validation Accountability Integrity

Validation remains connected to accountable governance structures.

F. Operational Architecture Space

AVS defines the operational architecture space for:

- authority validation governance
- authority verification
- authority legitimacy assessment
- authority-recognition governance
- validation criteria governance
- authority traceability
- validation accountability
- certification governance
- permission validation
- Human-AI authority validation
- agent-authority validation

This space exists because authority cannot be assumed.

Authority must be validated.

AVS governs whether authority remains valid.

G. Difference Between Authority and Authority

Validation

Authority defines the right to act.

Authority validation defines whether that right remains legitimate and recognizable.

Authority may exist without validation.

Validation cannot exist without authority.

AGS governs authority.

AVS governs validation of authority.

Both are required.

H. Runtime Position

AVS operates as the fourth foundational layer of AGA™.

It follows:

- Relationship Accountability Standard (RAS)
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- Authority Governance Standard (AGS)
- Authority Delegation Standard (ADS)

and supports:

- Authority Escalation Standard (AES)
- Responsibility Governance Standard (RGS)
- Capability Readiness Governance Standard (CRGS)
- Chain of Control Standard (CCS)
- Governance Oversight Standard (GOS)

AVS governs whether authority remains valid before governance relies upon it.

I. Authority Validation Failure Rule

Authority validation failure occurs when authority claims cannot be reliably verified, reconstructed, governed, validated, or connected to legitimate validation structures.

Examples include:

- expired authority
- fraudulent authority claims
- unverifiable authority
- undocumented validation
- invalid certifications
- governance-blind approvals
- authority-recognition failures
- invalid delegated authority

AVS exists to expose and govern these conditions.

J. Validity Logic

An authority-validation environment is valid under AVS when:

- authority remains verifiable
- validation origin remains traceable
- validation criteria remain visible
- validation legitimacy remains recognizable
- validation accountability remains preservable
- authority recognition remains governable
- validation remains reconstructable

An authority-validation environment becomes invalid when:

- authority cannot be verified
- validation origin is unknown
- validation criteria disappear
- legitimacy cannot be demonstrated
- validation accountability is lost
- validation cannot be reconstructed

K. Relationship to Other OOF Standards

AVS derives from:

- Relationship Accountability Standard (RAS)
- Authority Governance Standard (AGS)
- Authority Delegation Standard (ADS)

and supports:

- Authority Escalation Standard (AES)
- Responsibility Governance Standard (RGS)
- Capability Readiness Governance Standard (CRGS)
- Chain of Control Standard (CCS)
- Governance Oversight Standard (GOS)
- Accountability Governance Standard (AGS-A)

AGS governs authority.

ADS governs movement of authority.

AVS governs whether authority remains valid.

L. Foundational Principle

Authority should never be assumed. Authority must remain continuously verifiable.

Canonical Closing Statement

Authority Validation Standard (AVS) defines the structural conditions under which authority remains verifiable, legitimate, recognizable, traceable, governable, accountable, reconstructable, and operationally valid throughout its lifecycle.

Authority may exist and authority may be delegated, but governance cannot rely upon authority that cannot be validated. Authority validation governance therefore becomes a foundational condition of

Module Architecture

→ [AVOIM — Authority Validation Origin Integrity Module](#)

→ [AVCIM — Authority Validation Criteria Integrity Module](#)

→ [AVVIM — Authority Validation Validity Integrity Module](#)

→ [AVTIM — Authority Validation Traceability Integrity Module](#)

→ [AVAIM — Authority Validation Accountability Integrity Module](#)

Related Documents

→ [About the Authority Validation Standard - \(AVS\)](#)

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Canonical Source

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